AISHWARYA GHOSH

Department of Economics, University of Utah
· 260 S Central Campus Dr #4100, Salt Lake City, UT 84112
aishwarya.ghosh@utah.edu ghoshash1.github.io

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Utah (qualifier distinction) Expected May 2027

Committee: Marshall Steinbaum (Chair), Haimanti Bhattacharya, Peilu Zhang, Alberto Garcia, Levi Pace

M.A. in Economics, University of Hyderabad, India (distinction) 2018

B.Sc. (Hons.) in Economics, University of Calcutta, India (first class) 2016

Fields

Environmental and Energy Economics; Public Economics; Empirical Industrial Organization; Behavioral and Experimental Economics

Job Market Paper

"Does It Matter Who Sells the Car? - Regulation and Incidence of a Targeted Electric Vehicle Subsidy"

Abstract: I estimate how the launch of a targeted electric vehicle subsidy affects local transaction prices and sales, and whether the effect differs between dealers the program's price rules reach and those they do not. To answer this, I exploit California's Clean Cars 4 All subsidy program, launched in 2019, which restricts subsidy redemption to authorized dealerships that has to accept those rules, while dealers that do not enroll compete in the same local market under no such constraints. Linking transaction-level data on the universe of California EV sales from 2015 to 2023 to the subsidy program records, I estimate difference-in-differences specifications comparing buyers of the same make, model and model year in the same quarter, in the aggregate and by dealer participation channel. I first show that prices rose 0.6 to 1.0 percent in exposed relative to never-exposed areas, or $346 to $562 per vehicle, while sales grew more slowly. The aggregate price effect is at least three times as large as the entire program budget could generate if the subsidy were absorbed only into the prices of subsidized vehicles, pointing to a market-level price response rather than capture at the point of sale. I then show that the increase is concentrated outside the program. Prices rose 1.1 percent at non-participating dealers, where no buyer could redeem the subsidy, while at participating dealers the effect is statistically indistinguishable from zero and bounded above by $306, under 4 percent of the average subsidy. Tesla, which posts uniform national prices and does not respond locally, shows no effect either. Suggestive evidence points to a local market too tight to absorb the demand the program concentrates on a narrow set of eligible vehicles and participating dealers. Rules governing the sellers who redeem a subsidy can work where they apply and still leave the subsidy raising the cost of adoption elsewhere in the same market, for buyers it never reached in the communities it was designed to serve.

Research in Progress

Environmental and Energy Economics

"Charging the Competition: Public Electric Vehicle Infrastructure and the Charging-Network Divide"

"Urban Trees, Crime, and Spillovers" (with Alberto Garcia, Jacob Gellman, and Michelle Lee)

Supported by grant from Arnold Ventures, "Urban Trees and Social Outcomes"

Abstract: Urban tree planting initiatives increasingly aim to reduce environmental inequity in low-income communities, yet these efforts have faced resistance from residents concerned that trees may increase crime by providing concealment for criminal activity. We estimate the effect of tree cover on several categories of crime to help address this concern. To identify this relationship, we use an instrumental variables approach that takes advantage of a shock to tree cover induced by the introduction and spread of the emerald ash borer, an invasive beetle that targets ash trees. We combine geolocated data on crime, lidar-derived tree cover, and ash borer detections for a five-year period in Milwaukee, Wisconsin. Our IV estimates indicate that a 10 percentage point increase in net canopy share relative to the 2015 baseline reduces total crime by approximately 10 percent and nonviolent crime by approximately 20 percent relative to the tract-level mean. The nonviolent crime reduction is driven primarily by property crime, which declines by approximately 19 percent, and in particular by theft. Violent crime shows no statistically significant response. We find weak evidence in favor of temperature as one mechanism through which trees may affect crime. Spillovers resulting from tree cover loss in nearby areas appear to play no significant role in crime dynamics, suggesting that the crime-reducing effects of tree cover are primarily local.

Behavioral and Experimental Economics

"Risk Tolerance and the Decision to Consider an Electric Vehicle—An Experimental Study" (with Peilu Zhang)

Supported by grant from the University of Utah Clinical and Translational Science Institute

"Depression and Risk Preferences: Evidence from Multiple Elicitation Methods" (with Sarah Shizuko Morimoto, Evan V. Goldstein, and Peilu Zhang) — **under review**

Supported by grant from the University of Utah Clinical and Translational Science Institute

Abstract: The relationship between depression and risk preferences remains contested, with mixed evidence on whether individuals with depression are more risk-averse or risk-seeking than their non-depressed counterparts. This paper provides a systematic comparison of the depression–risk relationship across five distinct elicitation methods—the Holt–Laury multiple price list, Eckel–Grossman gamble choice, Gneezy–Potters investment task, Balloon Analogue Risk Task, and Domain-Specific Risk-Taking Scale—administered to comparable samples recruited from the same online platform with identical demographic stratification. We find that across measures, the general trend is toward lower risk aversion among individuals with depression, which manifests most clearly in the Holt–Laury task. A post-task survey suggests that this task's sequential structure and balance between deliberation and complexity allow it to detect preference differences that simpler instruments miss. For self-reported measures, our results highlight a divergence between general and domain-specific risk attitudes. Individuals with depression report lower willingness to take risks in general but higher willingness in health-specific contexts.

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Bräuner, T., Ghosh, A., & Ghosh, S. (2025). "Understanding responses of people with ASD in diverse reasoning tasks: A formal study." *Cognitive Processing*, 26(1), 201–218.

Refereed Conference Proceedings

Bräuner, T., Ghosh, A., & Ghosh, S. (2021). "Understanding responses of individuals with ASD in syllogistic and decision-making tasks: A formal study." *Lecture Notes in Computer Science*, 12524, 118–128 (SEFM 2020 Workshops).

Fellowships and Awards

- Wilkes Dissertation Fellowship, Wilkes Center for Climate Science and Policy 2026

- Graduate Research Fellowship, Utah Project on Antitrust and Consumer Protection, University of Utah 2023–24
- CSBS Graduate Travel Award, University of Utah 2024
- Qualified National Eligibility Test (Assistant Professor), UGC, India 2020

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record, University of Utah 2023–2026

Department of Economics and School of Public Affairs
Mathematics for Economics (Fall 2024, Fall 2025, Spring 2026); Principles of Econometrics (Spring 2025); Intermediate Microeconomics (Summer 2024, 2025); Economics and Public Policy Statistics (Summer 2024); Principles of Microeconomics (Summer 2023)

Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of Utah 2021–2023

Principles of Microeconomics; Principles of Econometrics; Feminist Economics; U.S. Economic History

Quantitative Methods Tutor (QPod), University of Utah 2022–2023

Presentations and Invited Talks

"Dealers, Pricing, and Local Market Dynamics of Targeted EV Subsidies": WEAI 2026; Applied Young Economists Webinar 2026; Eastern Economic Association 2024; Western States Graduate Workshop 2023; Applied Microeconomics Workshop, University of Utah 2023

"Accessing Non-Public Data": invited talk, Career Development Workshop, University of Utah, 2025

"Understanding Responses of Individuals with ASD in Syllogistic and Decision-Making Tasks": Western States Graduate Workshop 2022; Heidelberg University Summer School 2022; Symposium on Logic and Cognition 2021; CIFMA 2020, co-located with SEFM, CWI Amsterdam

Research Experience

Research Assistant, University of Utah and University of Chicago Summer 2026

Fulya Ersoy, Peilu Zhang, Pavitra Govindan, Matthew Brown, Tomar Yehoshua-Sandak

Utah Project Fellow, University of Utah 2023–2024

Marshall Steinbaum

Research Fellow, Indian Statistical Institute and Roskilde University 2024

Torben Bräuner and Sujata Ghosh

Research Fellow, Indian Statistical Institute and University of Groningen 2021

Sujata Ghosh, Rineke Verbrugge, and Harmen de Weerd

Workshops and Summer Schools

- Applied Young Economists Webinar, Environmental Economics, Monash Business School 2026
- Applied Microeconomics Workshops, University of Utah 2021–2023
- Behavioral Workshops, University of Utah 2021–2023
- Third International Rationality Summer Institute, Heidelberg University 2022

- "ReLaX" Workshop on Games, UMI ReLaX, Indo-French Joint Research Unit 2021
- Virtual Seminar Series on Behavioral and Experimental Economics, ESA 2020

Service

- Vice President, Heterodox Economics Student Association, University of Utah 2022–2023
- Moderator and Member, Young Economist Conclave, University of Hyderabad 2017–2018
- Volunteer, National Conference by Bangiya Arthaniti Parishad, Calcutta 2014
- Community Service Member, National Service Scheme, Government of India 2013–2016

Skills

Software: Stata, R, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Qualtrics, LaTeX, GitHub
Languages: Bengali (native), English (fluent), Hindi (fluent), French (beginner)

References

Dr. Marshall Steinbaum
Assistant Professor, Department of Economics
University of Utah
+1 (801) 581-7481
marshall.steinbaum@utah.edu

Dr. Alberto Garcia
Assistant Professor, Department of Economics

University of Utah
albert.garcia@utah.edu

Dr. Haimanti Bhattacharya
Professor, Department of Economics
University of Utah
+1 (801) 587-8350
haimanti.bhattacharya@utah.edu

Dr. Peilu Zhang
Assistant Professor, Department of Population Health Sciences
University of Utah
+1 (217) 979-0697
peilu.zhang@utah.edu